STORIES OF GUTS, GRIT AND GLORY

The M/o MSMEs nurtures the spirit of entrepreneurship to help the country realise the goal of **Aatmanirbhar Bharat.** Here is a look at some of the remarkable success stories scripted by enterprising men and women aided by the support of the NSSH under the Ministry:



"Don't wait. The Time will never be just right," says 31-year-old **SIDDHARTH GAUTAM.** Born in a middle class family in a small town in Raebareli district, Uttar Pradesh, Gautam got selected for the Institute Of Hotel Management Catering Technology & Applied Nutrition (IHMH), Hyderabad. He started his career as Food Production Incharge in five star hotels. Subsequently, Gautam joined Chokhi Dhani Foods Pvt Ltd, Jaipur as Food Production Manager and got the hang of the food processing industry. Here, he used to work with a team of 25 people, whose monthly turnover was Rs 20-30 crore. Sensing the immense scope in the food industry, he quit his job, driven by a desire to set forth a successful business model to motivate the youth of his village. In 2015, he set up his own firm, a small Chakki setup for manufacturing spices named MG Foods & Services at Raebareli.

Benefitted from the Scheme of National SC-ST Hub Office (NSSHO), Lucknow. This scheme helped him set up his own manufacturing and processing unit to provide pure and authentic spices of superior quality to his customers.



"My goal is to reduce the health risks and environmental impacts of global warming and add new food items to the table with mycelium-derived products," says **HENRY SAINGURA**, founder of Foods Myco Lab Mizoram. A young entrepreneur, he has successfully shown how food science technology can be used for social good. Brought up in a farming family in a small town in Mizoram, he had a dream to help farmers adopt smart ways of agriculture. As he entered college, he saw his fellow students only aiming for government jobs with many ending up jobless after years of studies due to paucity of such jobs. This only strengthened his desire to become an entrepreneur and bring about change in the agrarian sector!

He started his entrepreneurship journey by volunteering under the guidance of Divya Rawat in Soumya Food Private Ltd Dehradun for two years. After completing BSc in Food Technology from Uttarakhand, he came back to Mizoram in 2018 to start a new venture in mushroom cultivation.

Benefitted under the NSSH scheme to meet his venture's financial requirements. The NSIC also introduced him to subsidy facilities under Prime Minister Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP), and helped him in MSME registration as well as getting marketing support.



In 2013, **SOVIT MUNDHRA** realised that there is a lot of potential for Kolkata arts and handicrafts in the global market. He founded Kids Mandi to manufacture handmade gift products in 2014 in Kumartuli, the place known for using earth clay (terracotta) to create idols for worship on various occasions.

Today his firm has reached out to more than 2,00,000 customers in more than 14 countries. Customers can place orders for even a single unit via the online web technology. The company has also established distributors to market its goods locally and this has helped it in penetrating the market deeper and increasing its sales volume. Apart from domestic exhibition in Park Circus, Kolkata, Kids Mandi has participated in premium international exhibitions in Tokyo, Japan and Den Haag, Netherlands to showcase its products to the world.

Benefitted from the Special Marketing Assistance Scheme under NSSH for Promotion and Marketing Support. A platform to host manufacturers from all over India in major exhibitions, this scheme connected the firm to global buyers. Thanks to unique nature of its products, such exposure has provided the company with business relationships with fellow NSIC participants and new clients.